

# Central African Republic

**Ratio:** 2:3 **Adopted:** December 1, 1958 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red, yellow, and green are Pan-African colors

*The star represents hope of a union under France*



Red, white, and blue are taken from the French *Tricolore*

*The vertical stripe represents unity and the blood of humanity*

Africa



Previously known as Ubangui-Shari, the **Central African Republic** was formed as an autonomous state in 1958 under French protection.

The flag is unique in that it combines the Pan-African colors with those of France, the former colonial power. This was done in the hope that neighboring states would join a federation under French protection, but this never materialized; the star represents the hope of achieving this goal. The state became an empire

under the Emperor Bokassa from 1976–79, but no change was made to the national symbols.

The coat of arms is intended to symbolize both the Central African Republic and its important position in the center of Africa. The upper scroll bears the motto of the former ruling party; it means “A Man is a Man.”

## ARMS OF THE CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC

*An elephant and a baobab tree*

*The national motto—“Unité, Dignité, Travail” meaning “Unity, Dignity, Work”*



*The central feature is a gold star on a map of Africa, symbolizing the position of the Central African Republic*

*The hand was the party emblem of the dominant party in 1963, when the arms was adopted*